
3.6 Unit 3, Topic D: Structures of Global Politics

Focus This topic provides an introduction to global politics by examining key global political structures and systems.

What students need to learn: *Students taking Unit 3, Topic D must learn all areas within the topic.*

Approaches to Global Politics

Key concepts	Content explanation
sovereignty the nation state theories of global politics globalisation interdependence transnational corporations global and local	■ A knowledge of the divisions between realism and idealism, and of the ideas of an anarchic international system and a society of states. ■ A knowledge of the processes of globalisation and its impact on the states system. ■ A knowledge of the factors driving globalisation (economic, cultural, political) and an awareness of debates about the impact of globalisation, and particularly its implications for the nation-state, and debates about the benefits and drawbacks of globalisation.

World Order

Key concepts	Content explanation
power balance of power polarity hegemony nationalism	■ The main focus of the topic will be on developments in the post-1989 period. ■ A knowledge of the changing nature of world order in the 20th and 21st centuries, and an ability to discuss the effects of events such as the collapse of communism on the nature of global order, including an awareness of the implications of conditions such as bipolarity, unipolarity and multipolarity. ■ A knowledge of the differing significance of states in global affairs, of the importance of power (both hard and soft) and why, for instance, some states are classified as great powers or superpowers, or as 'emerging powers'.

Global Governance

Key concepts	Content explanation
international organisations governance intergovernmentalism supranationalism	■ Knowledge of the origins, development and role of major global institutions, from 1945, in relation to the key problems of global politics. ■ The emphasis will be on the role, performance and significance of the United Nations, but students should also have knowledge of other key bodies such as the North Atlantic Treaty Organisation (NATO) and institutions of global economic governance such as the International Monetary Fund (IMF), World Bank, World Trade Organization (WTO) and the Group of Eight (G8).

European Union and Regionalism

Key concepts	Content explanation
Euro-federalism national sovereignty subsidiarity regionalisation	■ Knowledge of the origins and development of the EEC/EC/EU, of the general factors that have fostered European integration, of the major developments through which this has occurred, particularly economic and monetary union, of the process of enlargement, and significance of the EU as an international body. ■ A knowledge of the growth of regional integration globally, of regionalisation organisations outside of Europe, and of debates about the reasons for, and significance of, regionalisation. (<i>Essay questions will not be set on non-European regional organisations.</i>)